

Word family: immediate / immediately / immediacy

Base word: immediate

Adverb: immediately

Noun: immediacy

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / noun (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

“...so the ad **immediately** caught my attention.”

A full semantic sweep shows that this family has one strong underlying concept:

with nothing important in between — no waiting, no intervening step, no greater distance, or no more remote relationship

From that, modern English develops several major uses:

- happening without delay;
- nearest in time;
- nearest in physical space;
- closest/direct relationship;
- direct consequence or cause;
- most urgent/current concern;
- **immediately before/after**;
- formal **immediately = as soon as**;
- **immediacy** = directness/urgency/present impact.

Meaning in your passage

Here:

“the ad **immediately** caught my attention”

means:

the advertisement attracted the speaker’s attention at once, without any noticeable delay.

繁體中文：立刻；馬上；沒有任何明顯延遲地

Natural translation:

“...so the ad immediately caught my attention.”

「.....所以那則廣告立刻吸引了我的注意力。」

Here:

immediately = 某件事情在另一件事情發生後幾乎沒有任何等待便出現

1. immediate = happening without delay (行動／反應／效果) — 立即的; 即時的

This is the adjective corresponding to your original **immediately**.

Practice 1

“The medicine provided **immediate relief**.”

「這種藥帶來了立即的舒緩效果。」

Practice 2

“The problem requires **immediate action**.”

「這個問題需要立即採取行動。」

immediate = 不需要等待, 幾乎在當下便發生或需要處理的

Common:

- immediate action = 立即行動
 - immediate response = 即時回應
 - immediate effect = 即時效果
 - immediate attention = 立即處理／關注
 - immediate relief = 即時舒緩
-

2. immediately = at once / without delay — 立即; 馬上

This is your original form.

Practice 3 — Original

“The ad **immediately** caught my attention.”

「那則廣告立刻吸引了我的注意力。」

Practice 4

“Please reply **immediately**.”

「請立即回覆。」

Practice 5

“The noise stopped **immediately**.”

「噪音馬上停止了。」

immediately = 某個動作或變化沒有等待，很快便發生

3. immediate = nearest in time (時間上最近) — 緊接的; 最近的

Here, **immediate** does not necessarily mean “fast.”

It means **the next closest point in time**.

Practice 6

“The **immediate future** is uncertain.”

「近期／眼前的未來仍不確定。」

Practice 7

“In the **immediate aftermath** of the accident, the road was closed.”

「事故發生後的最初一段時間／緊接其後，道路被封閉。」

immediate — time = 與目前／某事件在時間上最接近，沒有其他重要階段隔在中間的

Common:

- immediate future = 近期
 - immediate past = 最近一段過去
 - immediate aftermath = 事件剛發生後的階段
-

4. **immediately before / immediately after** (時間順序) — 緊接在.....之前／之後

A very important construction.

Practice 8

“I called her **immediately after** the meeting.”

「會議結束後我馬上／緊接著打電話給她。」

Practice 9

“The announcement came **immediately before** the launch.”

「公告在產品發布緊接之前發出。」

immediately before/after = 在時間上與另一事件緊貼相連，中間幾乎沒有其他事情／時間

Here **immediately** can mean both:

- very soon;
 - directly adjacent in sequence.
-

5. immediate = nearest in physical space (位置) — 緊鄰的; 附近的; 眼前的

A distinct spatial extension.

Practice 10

“There were no shops in the **immediate area**.”

「附近一帶／緊鄰地區沒有商店。」

Practice 11

“Check your **immediate surroundings**.”

「檢查你身邊附近的環境。」

immediate — space = 在物理位置上最接近，沒有較遠距離隔開的

Common:

- immediate area = 附近一帶
 - immediate surroundings = 身邊周圍環境
 - immediate vicinity = 鄰近範圍
-

6. immediately next to / behind / in front of (空間) — 就在.....旁邊／後面／前面

Practice 12

“The café is **immediately next to** the station.”

「咖啡店就在車站旁邊。」

Practice 13

“The office is **immediately above** the shop.”

「辦公室就在商店正上方。」

immediately + spatial expression = 在空間上直接相鄰, 中間沒有其他明顯位置隔開

This is different from temporal “馬上.”

7. immediate family (家庭關係) — 直系／最親近家庭成員

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 14

“Only **immediate family** members were invited.”

「只有最親近的家庭成員／直系親屬獲邀。」

Practice 15

“The form asks for details of your **immediate family**.”

「表格要求填寫你的直系／最親近家庭成員資料。」

immediate family = 與本人家庭關係最直接、最親近的一組家人

Exact legal definitions vary by context, but commonly may include:

- spouse/partner
- parents
- children
- siblings

So **immediate** here means **relationship distance is closest**, not “fast.”

8. immediate superior / manager / supervisor (組織層級) — 直接上司；直屬主管

Practice 16

“Report the issue to your **immediate supervisor**.”

「把問題報告給你的直屬主管。」

Practice 17

“Her **immediate manager** approved the request.”

「她的直接上司批准了申請。」

immediate superior/manager = 在組織層級中直接管理你、與你之間沒有另一級主管隔著的人

Same underlying idea:

nothing in between

9. **immediate** = direct, without intermediary (關係／來源) — 直接的；第一手的

Practice 18

“The decision had an **immediate impact** on employees.”

「這個決定對員工產生了直接而即時的影響。」

Practice 19

“The witness had **immediate knowledge** of what happened.”

「那名證人對事件具有直接／第一手了解。」

immediate = 與某人／某結果直接相連，中間沒有其他重要人物、步驟或媒介

This sense often overlaps with “direct.”

10. **immediate cause** (原因) — 直接原因；最直接導火線

A useful academic/legal/scientific collocation.

Practice 20

“The **immediate cause** of the failure was a power cut.”

「故障的直接原因是停電。」

Practice 21

“The investigation identified the **immediate cause** of the accident.”

「調查找出了事故的最直接原因。」

immediate cause = 最直接導致某件事情發生的原因，而不是較深層／較遠的背景原因

Important contrast:

- immediate cause = 直接原因
 - underlying/root cause = 深層／根本原因
-

11. immediate effect/consequence (結果) — 直接／即時效果；直接後果

Practice 22

“The new rule had an **immediate effect**.”

「新規則產生了即時效果。」

Practice 23

“The **immediate consequences** were relatively minor.”

「最直接、最初出現的後果相對輕微。」

immediate consequence/effect = 某件事情發生後最先、最直接產生的影響

This can combine two ideas:

- no delay;

- directness.
-

12. immediate concern/problem/priority (當前最需要處理) — 當務之急; 眼前問題; 首要事項

A useful abstract meaning.

Practice 24

“Safety is our **immediate concern**.”

「安全是我們目前的首要關注事項／當務之急。」

Practice 25

“The **immediate priority** is to restore power.”

「眼前的首要任務是恢復電力供應。」

immediate = 在目前情況下最迫切、最需要先處理的

Here it means:

current + urgent, not merely “fast.”

13. no immediate danger/risk/need (目前沒有即時.....) — 當前沒有迫切.....

Practice 26

“There is no **immediate danger**.”

「目前沒有即時危險／迫切危險。」

Practice 27

“There is no **immediate need** to replace the device.”

「目前沒有急需更換裝置。」

no immediate X = 在眼前／短期內沒有迫切發生或處理的 **X**

This is especially common in:

- medical contexts
 - safety
 - business
 - risk assessment
-

14. **immediately = directly / with nothing intervening** (順序／關係) — 緊接地；直接地

This use often appears with location/time/rank.

Practice 28

“Her office is **immediately below** mine.”

「她的辦公室就在我的正下方。」

Practice 29

“The section **immediately following** the introduction explains the method.”

「緊接引言之後的部分解釋研究方法。」

immediately = 在順序、位置或關係上直接相鄰，沒有其他東西隔在中間

This is genuinely broader than “馬上.”

15. **immediately = as soon as** (連接詞；較正式／英式) — —……就……

This is a less obvious but useful modern use, especially in British/formal English.

Practice 30

“**Immediately** he arrived, the meeting began.”

「他一到達，會議就開始了。」

Practice 31

“Immediately she heard the news, she called her family.”

「她一聽到消息，就打電話給家人。」

immediately + clause = as soon as; 某事一發生，另一件事便隨即發生

Register: more formal/literary and especially associated with British usage.

In everyday speech, **as soon as** is usually safer.

16. immediacy = quality of feeling direct/present/urgent — 即時感; 迫切性; 直接感

The main noun in the family.

Practice 32

“Live television creates a sense of **immediacy**.”

「現場電視直播會營造一種事情正在眼前發生的即時感。」

Practice 33

“The photograph has a strong sense of **immediacy**.”

「這張照片帶有很強的直接臨場感。」

immediacy = 某件事情感覺非常直接、當下、貼近眼前或迫切的特質

This is especially common in:

- media
 - art
 - journalism
 - communication
-

17. immediacy = urgency / need for quick action — 迫切性; 即時需要

Practice 34

“The **immediacy** of the problem required a quick response.”

「問題的迫切性要求迅速作出回應。」

Practice 35

“The report failed to convey the **immediacy** of the threat.”

「報告未能傳達這項威脅的迫切程度。」

immediacy = 某個問題需要立刻關注／處理的迫切程度

This is related to but distinct from artistic “臨場感.”

Important distinction: immediate vs instant

immediate

= without significant delay; can also mean nearest/direct.

instant

more strongly emphasizes an extremely short or virtually zero delay.

“an immediate response”

「立即回應」

“instant payment”

「即時付款」

They overlap, but **immediate** has many meanings that **instant** does not:

immediate family ✓

instant family ✗ in this meaning

immediate supervisor ✓

instant supervisor ✗

Important distinction: immediate vs urgent

immediate

often tells us **when** something must happen:
right away.

urgent

tells us **how important/time-sensitive** it is.

“The patient needs immediate treatment.”

= 治療需要馬上開始。

“The case is urgent.”

= 個案十分緊急。

Something urgent often requires immediate action, but the concepts are not identical.

Important distinction: immediate vs direct

They overlap in some senses.

immediate

= nothing intervening in time, space, relationship, or causation.

direct

= straight/unmediated connection or route.

“my immediate supervisor”

= 我的直屬主管

“my direct supervisor”

also possible.

But:

“immediate action”

= 立即行動

not:

“direct action”

because **direct action** has a different meaning.

Important distinction: immediate vs current

current

= existing now.

immediate

= closest/most urgent now.

“Our current problem is cost.”

「我們目前的問題是成本。」

“Our immediate problem is safety.”

「我們眼前最迫切的問題是安全。」

Immediate often adds urgency or proximity.

Important distinction: immediately vs soon

immediately

= with essentially no delay.

soon

= after a short period of time, but not necessarily right away.

“Call me immediately.”

「立刻打給我。」

“Call me soon.”

「遲些／盡快打給我。」

The second allows more delay.

Important distinction: immediately vs directly

immediately

can mean:

- at once;
- directly adjacent.

directly

can mean:

- in a straight/direct way;
- personally;
- sometimes “immediately” in certain varieties.

Example:

“Come immediately.”

= 馬上來。

“Contact me directly.”

= 直接聯絡我，不經其他人。

Do not assume they are always interchangeable.

Important distinction: immediately vs instantly

instantly

often sounds even more abrupt/zero-delay.

“The screen turned off instantly.”

「螢幕瞬間關掉。」

immediately

can be slightly more neutral and institutional:

“Please report the problem immediately.”

「請立即報告問題。」

Important distinction: immediate family vs extended family

immediate family

= 最親近／直系家庭成員

extended family

= 更廣泛親屬，如祖父母、叔伯姨舅、堂表兄弟姊妹等

Exact boundaries can vary culturally/legal-contextually.

Important distinction: immediate cause vs root cause

immediate cause

= directly triggered the event.

root cause

= deeper underlying reason that allowed the problem to develop.

Example:

Immediate cause: the machine overheated.

Root cause: maintenance had been neglected.

直接原因: 機器過熱

根本原因: 長期缺乏保養

Word-position note

Before noun:

immediate action

immediate family

immediate concern

Adverb:

respond immediately

Temporal positioning:

immediately before

immediately after

Spatial positioning:

immediately next to

immediately above

The Chinese meaning changes significantly according to what follows.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the genuinely useful modern family is relatively compact:

- **immediate — no delay** = 立即的／即時的
- **immediate — nearest in time** = 緊接的／近期的
- **immediate — nearest in space** = 緊鄰／附近的
- **immediate family** = 最親近／直系家庭成員
- **immediate supervisor/manager** = 直屬主管
- **immediate — direct relation** = 直接的
- **immediate cause** = 直接原因
- **immediate effect/consequence** = 即時／直接效果
- **immediate concern/priority** = 眼前最迫切事項
- **immediately — at once** = 立即／馬上
- **immediately before/after** = 緊接之前／之後
- **immediately + spatial phrase** = 就在／直接相鄰
- **immediately = as soon as** = 一……就……(較正式)
- **immediacy — direct/present quality** = 即時感／臨場感
- **immediacy — urgency** = 迫切性

There are not many useful broader derivatives beyond **immediacy**, so under our rule I would stop here rather than inflate the family artificially.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
immediate — no delay	不需要等待，幾乎在當下便發生或需要處理的
immediate — nearest in time	與目前／某事件在時間上最接近，中間沒有其他重要階段的
immediate — nearest in space	在物理位置上最接近、緊鄰或附近的
immediate family	與本人家庭關係最直接、最親近的一組家庭成員
immediate supervisor	在組織中直接管理本人、中間沒有另一級主管的上司

immediate — direct relationship	與某人／某結果直接相連，中間沒有其他重要媒介或步驟的
immediate cause	最直接導致某件事情發生的原因，而非深層背景原因
immediate effect/consequence	某件事情發生後最先／最直接產生的影響
immediate concern/priority	在目前情況下最迫切、最需要先處理的事項
immediately — at once	某個行動或變化沒有等待，馬上發生
immediately before/after	在時間順序上緊貼另一事件之前／之後
immediately — spatially	在空間上直接相鄰，中間沒有其他東西隔開
immediately = as soon as	某事一發生，另一件事便隨即發生；一……就……
immediacy — present/direct quality	事情感覺貼近眼前、正在當下發生的直接感／臨場感
immediacy — urgency	問題需要迅速關注或處理的迫切程度

For your original sentence

“...so the ad **immediately caught my attention.**”

The exact meaning is:

immediately = 廣告出現後幾乎沒有任何延遲，我的注意力便立刻被它吸引

So naturally:

“**The ad immediately caught my attention.**”

=「那則廣告立刻吸引了我的注意力。」

And this redo reveals an important point: **immediate** is not merely「立即的」. Its deeper concept is “**nothing intervening**”, which explains why English can naturally say:

- **immediate response** → 立即回應
- **immediate family** → 最親近家人
- **immediate supervisor** → 直屬主管
- **immediate area** → 鄰近範圍
- **immediate cause** → 直接原因

—all from the same underlying semantic idea.